Research Pipeline Design

2026-10-22

Overview

Two commands for reading the literature with Claude Code: one finds the papers that matter on a topic, the other takes a single paper apart.

The problem both solve is trust. A literature answer is only useful if every paper in it is real, correctly attributed and worth reading, and if the analysis separates what the paper says from what the reader should think of it. So the pipeline is built around **trusted sources** and **verification before citation**.

Command	Input	Output
`/research-list-paper`	a topic or keywords	`.research/lists/<date>-<topic>.md` — the key papers, foundational and recent
`/research-summary-paper`	a title, arXiv ID, DOI or PDF	`.research/papers/<author><year>-<title>.md` — big picture, claims, evidence, limitations

Principles

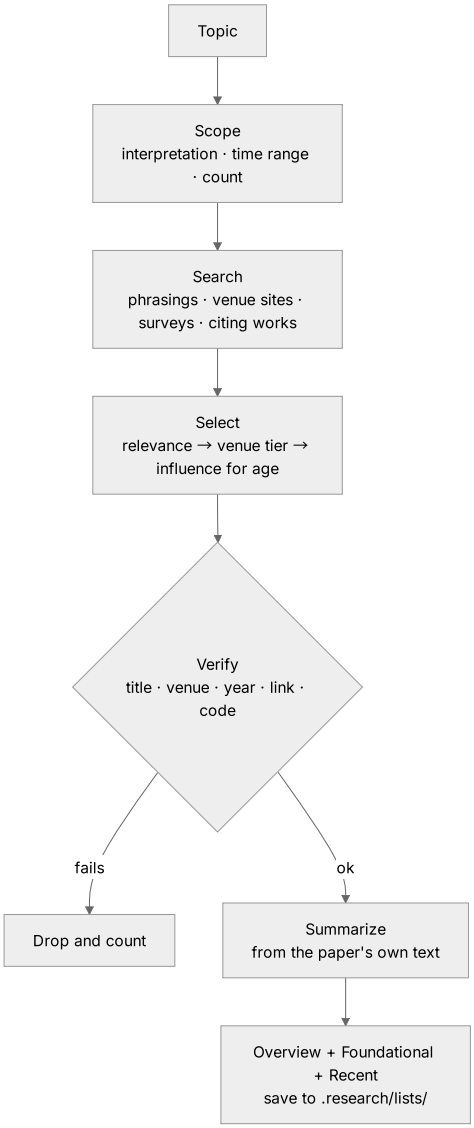
Nothing unverified gets cited. Every title, venue, year, link and code repo is confirmed from a fetched page before it appears. Search snippets and memory are for finding candidates, never for citing them. An entry that can't be verified is dropped, and the output says how many were dropped.

Trusted venues first. Peer-reviewed papers from established venues (CVPR, ICCV/ECCV, SIGGRAPH, NeurIPS, ICML, ICLR, IEEE journals, ...) rank first. An arXiv-only paper is included only with a stated reason: adoption, the authors' track record, or a very recent result that already sets a direction.

The paper's voice and ours stay apart. Claims are attributed to the authors, with section and table references and exact numbers. Criticism is labeled as assessment and must point at something specific.

Output in the user's language. The kit is English; summaries and analyses follow the language of the request. Names of papers, venues, methods and datasets stay as published.

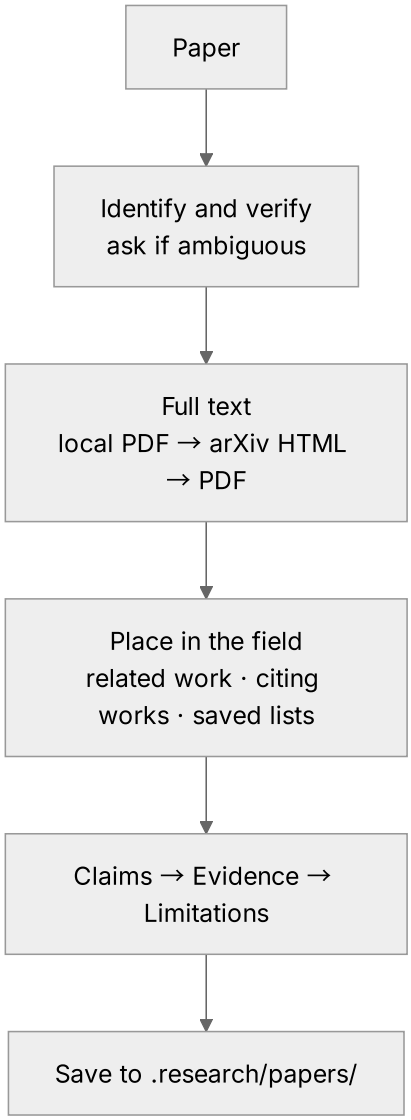
/research-list-paper



Each entry gives title, venue, year, an accessible paper link, the official code link (or `–`), why the paper is key, and a 2–3 sentence summary of the problem it tackles and how — or what it claims. An overview paragraph on top traces how the topic developed.

Defaults: 10–15 papers, split between foundational work and the last ~2 years. The request can change the range, the count or the focus.

/research-summary-paper



Section	Content
Big picture	the line of work it extends, the gap it targets, what came after (up to 10 follow-ups, grouped by direction)
Method in brief	how it works: inputs, core idea, outputs
Claims	what the authors claim, numbered, main contribution first; compound claims split
Evidence	per claim: assumptions, experiments (setup, numbers, ablations), proofs or explanations if any, and a one-line verdict
Limitations	acknowledged by the authors · gaps in the argument · room for improvement
Bottom line	what to take away and how much to trust it

Two checks are built in because they find the real issues most often: each claim is compared with the conditions it was actually tested under, and headline numbers are checked against the detailed tables.

If the full text or a linked supplement isn't available, the analysis says so at the top and stays within what was actually read. The chat shows only the bottom line and the verdicts; the full analysis is in the file.

Verification levels

Level	Applies to	Requires
Full check	each paper in a list; the paper being analyzed	title from the paper's page, venue + year from the venue's own record or DOI, a working link, official code confirmed
Light check	papers mentioned in passing (e.g. follow-ups)	one metadata record (OpenAlex, Crossref, Semantic Scholar or arXiv)

Anything that rests on a weaker source or couldn't be reached is written in the output's source note rather than silently asserted.

Sources

The skill `research-sources` holds the shared rules: venue tiers, arXiv-only criteria, the verification table, link priority and lookup services. Both commands read it first.

Discovery uses web search. Verification uses arXiv, Crossref, OpenAlex and Semantic Scholar APIs plus the venue sites (CVF Open Access, OpenReview, PMLR, NeurIPS proceedings, ACM DL). All work without keys; if `SEMANTIC_SCHOLAR_API_KEY` or `OPENALEX_API_KEY` is set, it is used. The pipeline never signs up for keys or sends the user's details anywhere.

Files

```
<project>/
├── CLAUDE.md                          research block (marker) — commands, language,
integrity
├── .claude/
│   ├── commands/
│   │   ├── research-list-paper.md
│   │   └── research-summary-paper.md
│   └── skills/research-sources/       source & verification rules
└── .research/
    ├── lists/                         /research-list-paper output
    └── papers/                        /research-summary-paper output
```

`/research-summary-paper` reads `.research/lists/` when placing a paper in its field, so earlier lists make later analyses better informed.